DLAC 2026 · BOOK STUDY · ATLANTA

Beyond the Chatbot

Stop talking about AI. Start building something.

James Harvey
Special Education Teacher · AI Ambassador
Agua Fria Union High School District
jharvey@aguafria.org
linkedin.com/in/jamesharvey1113

Five tools you can build this week. No coding degree. No new subscription.

1. **Scan** the code and pick a build.
2. Tap **Copy prompt + code**.
3. **Paste it into your AI** (ChatGPT, Gemini, Copilot, or Claude). It walks you through the build one step at a time.

jharvey1113.github.io/beyond-the-chatbot

FEATURED BUILDS · plus Build 5, the Email Traffic Cop, online

BUILD 1 · NO CODE · ANYONE

The Pocket Expert

A portable AI skill loaded with your standards and policies. Ready for the switch from GPTs and Gems to Plugins and Skills, with a prompt to convert yours.

Saves: answering the same 20 questions

BUILD 2 · TEACHERS · SPED

One-Click Parent Updates

Type a quick note next to each student, click one button, and every parent gets a personal email. Contact dates are logged automatically.

Saves: about 2 hours per round

BUILD 3 · OFFICE · DEPT. LEADS

The Sunday Night Briefing

Every Sunday at 6 PM, your team gets next week's IEPs, 504s, drills, and meetings in one clean email, pulled straight from the shared calendar.

Saves: "Nobody told me."

BUILD 4 · ADMIN · COUNSELORS

The Tiered Alert System

Attendance data sends the right email to the right people by tier and logs every contact. Starts in test mode, so families get nothing until you're ready.

Saves: catching kids at 5%, not 30 days

EVERY BUILD FOLLOWS ONE PATTERN

1 Get data · 2 Loop through it · 3 Check a condition · 4 Do something

The only difference between a tool for 30 students and one for 3,000 is more rows.

BEFORE YOU BUILD

- **Fake data first.** Test with your own email.
- **Describe the data. Never paste it** into a chat.
- **Always build a fail-safe:** "If not found, leave it for me."
- **Check district privacy & FERPA** rules first.

Finding your first build. A task is ready to automate when it shows one of these signs:

- **You do it every week,** the same way, by hand.
- **You copy and paste** between tabs, sheets, or systems.
- **You send the same email** to a lot of people, one at a time.
- **You scan a list** looking for who crossed a line.

WANT MORE BUILDS?

Get the book: *Beyond the Chatbot*

Step-by-step builds for paras, teachers, SPED, counselors, office staff, and admins, plus the chapters that keep your tools running.

Scan or click: amazon.com/dp/B0GQMYJ2XZ

Also at DLAC

The Reality Gap: What Students Really Think About AI

Tue, Oct 20 · 3:00 PM